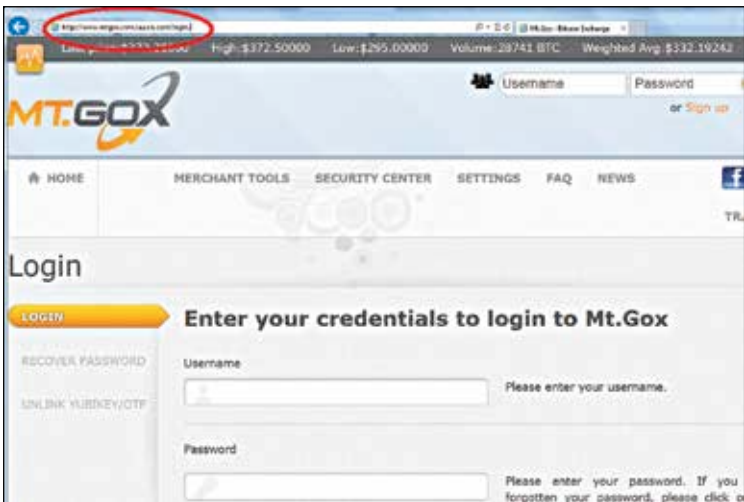


two methods - make users download malware or fool users into sending Bitcoins to incorrect address.

Criminals send out mass emails to thousands of email ids. Most emails seem innocuous and innocent, seemingly from people you may know. They usually have attachments or links to download files that seem relevant and important. But as is always the case, these files are trojan viruses or similar malware that can exploit and harm the user's system and Bitcoin assets irreparably. As is always the case, its easy to avoid this scam by simply not opening attachments or clicking on links from unknown sources, irrespective of what the mail claims.



An example of old-school phishing scam – a fake website. Always make sure your URLs are secure and correct.

Dangers for Bitcoin users

The world of Bitcoin is just emerging and with no central regulatory authority it falls on the collective network of people to maintain order. Just as many of the Bitcoin protocols are based on community consensus, from the rules of the rewards to the use of Bitcoin clients, it is necessary for users to keep close ties to the community through forums for up to date information regarding risks and dangers.

But because of the very nature of the Bitcoin design, people who are use to the traditional way of dealing with money and online activities